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est income minus total interest expenses as a percentage of average interest earning assets; penalties imposed by RBI during the year.

Capital adequacy and liquidity coverage: Capital adequacy ratio: capital to risk weighted assets ratio for FY22; Tier I capital: total of equity capital and disclosed reserves; liquidity coverage ratio: ratio of high-quality liquid assets (HQLA) to total net cash outflows over the following 30 calendar days.

Final scoring and rating

Each bank was assigned a score for each of the 34 sub-parameters based on its rank on those parameters. The score under each parameter was then multiplied by the parameter's weight to arrive at the final score. The results were

then aggregated to arrive at the final rankings based on the total score. In all, 44 banks were not considered for the survey due to mergers, amalgamations, liquidation, non-availability of annual reports in public domain for FY22, and balance sheet size of less than ₹5,000 crore (except in case of Indian small finance banks and foreign banks with a balance sheet size of less than ₹25,000 crore).

QUALITATIVE AWARDS

Three 'qualitative awards' recognised the initiatives and strategies undertaken by banks in the areas of innovation, fintech, talent and workforce; based on self-nomination responses to the survey by banks.

Best Bank in Innovation award: Banks had to describe their innovation initiatives across

the four critical focus areas of customer experience, business model, service delivery and digital adoption. Every initiative was evaluated and ranked based on four key parameters viz. area of impact, adoption level by the bank, impact created by the initiative and uniqueness of the solution.

Best Bank in Fintech Initiative award: Banks were asked to describe their fintech initiatives, which were evaluated and ranked based on four key parameters viz. area of impact, adoption level by the bank, impact created by the initiative and the uniqueness of the solution.

Best Bank in Talent & Workforce award: All participating banks were evaluated on interventions across four critical focus areas under talent and workforce management, innovation in talent management and digitalisation, initiatives around diversity and inclusion, employee experience and well-being and the future of the workforce. These four areas were further evaluated on uniqueness of idea, breadth of initiative, implementation evidence and impact achieved.

QUALITATIVE AWARDS

(Payments and value added services segments)

There were two qualitative award categories—payments and value added services.

The key parameters considered to evaluate fintech players were company health (for example, years of operation, revenue generated per employee), business maturity (equity raised, profitability metrics), funding maturity, business volumes of the company, differentiation (basis business models, product features, IP and technology, key focus and solutions) and adoption levels across different customer segments and geographies; along with current industrial partnerships. **BT**